



CP5046 ICT Project 1: Analysis and Design

Assessment Item 2

Project Plan for Welcome Mate: An XP-based Software Development Approach

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Version history

Version	Date	Changes
1.1	7 th Oct, 2024	Initial creation of the team charter, outlining team values and assigning roles.
1.2	15 th Oct, 2024	Conducted customer interviews and gathered detailed requirements. Created initial user stories.
1.3	18 th Oct, 2024	Developed the low-fidelity (lo-fi) prototype based on user stories and system metaphor.
1.4	21 st Oct, 2024	Incorporated customer feedback and started development of the high-fidelity (hifi) prototype.
1.5	22 nd Oct, 2024	Continued work on hifi prototype and integrated additional design feedback. Updated user stories.
1.6	25 th Oct, 2024	Finalized iteration planning and prepared for the XP iteration planning meeting. Updated project documentation and Notion board.

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1. Introduction

When an international student arrives in Australia for the first time without guidance, the experience can be overwhelming and isolating, potentially leading to mental health issues. From finding accommodation to understanding local customs and seeking for part time jobs, the initial days are filled with challenges that can hinder students from fully embracing their new environment. Welcome Mate offers a simple and effective solution to this problem. The platform provides essential guidance on the critical tasks that need to be completed upon arrival, such as finding part-time jobs, processing bank cards, navigating public transportation and finding accommodation. Additionally, Welcome Mate facilitates connections by helping students book a buddy for support, ensuring they have someone to turn to as they settle in.

Although numerous resources exist for international students about life in Australia, they often lack the straightforward, specific information that newcomers truly need. Navigating various websites for job applications or setting up a bank account can become a complex procedure. With Welcome Mate, starting life in Australia becomes a straightforward and welcoming experience.

2. Project Scope

Welcome Mate: A Guidance for International Students in Australia" is designed to provide a comprehensive, user-friendly digital resource tailored specifically for JCUB students, while also being accessible to international students from other universities. The guide will include essential information on accommodation, public transportation, part-time job opportunities, and banking procedures, delivered through a mobile app and website. Additionally, it will feature an online appointment booking system for personalized face-to-face assistance with advisors. Community engagement tools, such as forums and discussion groups, will be integrated to foster peer support among students.

3. Goals and Objectives

- **Develop a Comprehensive Resource Guide**
Create a user-friendly digital guide that consolidates essential information for international students in Australia, covering topics such as accommodation,

accessing public transportation, part-time job opportunities, and banking procedures.

- **Enhance Accessibility of Information**

Ensure the guide is easily accessible and provides clear, straightforward information tailored to the needs of international students.

- **Implement Appointment Booking System**

Design and develop an online appointment booking feature that allows JCUB students to schedule face-to-face assistance with advisors for personalized support.

- **Create a Support Community**

Foster a sense of community among international students by integrating forums or discussion groups within the guide, allowing students to share experiences, advice, and support.

4. Communication Plan

4.1 Purpose and Objectives

The purpose of the following communication strategy is to issue messages with the same aim regarding the overall process leading to the launch of Welcome Mate. It elaborates how the project team will communicate both within and beyond the team as well as with stakeholders to ensure that the messages reach all concerned.

The key objectives for the plan are:

- Ensure that everyone within the project team and various stakeholders will receive updates on project developments, analyses issues and how changes will be rectified.
- Broaden the data collection in terms of feedback assessment of the project status and requirements by incorporating stakeholder's opinions and expectations to the project.
- Management often has trouble working together, which slows down the project because of conflicting interests and a tense atmosphere. The project coordinator needs to fix this within the first two days.

4.2 Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Influence	Responsibility	Communication Method
Project Sponsor	High	Approve project scope, provide requirements	Email, SurveyMonkey
Team Members	High	Execute project tasks, provide updates	Weekly meetings, WhatsApp group
Clients (International Students)	High	Provide requirements through feedback and surveys	SurveyMonkey, interviews, online forums
JCUB Student Services	High	Provide insight into student needs	Weekly status reports, email communication
Advisors/Counselors	Medium	Offer personalized assistance and feedback	Email, online appointment system

Table 1 - Stakeholder roles and Communication

Various means will be adopted to improve communication allowing applying the most suitable strategy.

4.2.1 Project Meetings

Frequency: Weekly	Participants: All team members
Format: Video conferencing (Zoom/Google Meet)	Focus: Discuss project progress, next steps, issues, and upcoming tasks.

4.2.2 Team Collaboration Tools

- Platform: Notion for project management and documentation.
- Usage: Tracking project milestones, task assignments, deadlines, and progress.

4.2.3 Instant Messaging

- Platform: WhatsApp group for quick inquiries and urgent updates.

- Usage: Informal discussions, task reminders, urgent updates, and announcements.

4.2.4 Stakeholder Updates

- Frequency: Weekly updates via email or during meetings.
- Participants: Project sponsor, JCUB Student Services, and other stakeholders.
- Format: Status reports and presentations, including key milestones, progress, issues, and next steps.

4.2.5 Surveys and Feedback

- Tool: SurveyMonkey for gathering student input.
- Usage: Understanding student needs, challenges, and preferred features in the app.

4.2.6 User Testing and Feedback

- Frequency: After every major prototype iteration.
- Participants: Target users (international students).
- Format: Online surveys, usability testing sessions, feedback forms.

4.3 Key Communication Activities

Activity	Objective	Audience	Method	Frequency
Project kick-off Meeting	Align on goals, deliverables, and responsibilities	Team members, stakeholders	Zoom/Google Meet	Once (start of project)
Weekly Status Updates	Share project progress, address risks and issues	Project sponsor, JCUB Student Services	Email or meeting presentation	Weekly
Feedback Gathering via Surveys	Collect user requirements and feedback on features	Clients (international students)	SurveyMonkey, Interviews	Bi-weekly

Planning and Review Meetings	Review progress, define next tasks and priorities	Team members	Zoom/Google Meet	Bi-weekly
Usability Testing Sessions	Test app usability, gather student feedback	Target users (international students)	Online sessions, feedback forms	After each iteration
Project Closure Meeting	Present final project results, gather final feedback	All stakeholders	Zoom/Google Meet	Once (end of project)

Table 2 - Key Communication Activities

4.4 Communication Schedule

Activity	Details	Frequency
Project Progress Meetings	Discuss progress, upcoming tasks, blockers.	Weekly (Wednesdays)
Team Standups	Quick daily updates from team members to address immediate issues.	Daily
Stakeholder Reports	Send written reports to key stakeholders to summarize progress and gather input.	Weekly
Feedback and Surveys	Send feedback surveys and questionnaires to users and stakeholders to assess needs.	Bi-weekly
User Testing Feedback Sessions	Conduct feedback sessions with international students after major prototype iterations.	After each iteration

Table 3 - Communication Schedule

4.5 Escalation Process

Should any issues arise, that cannot be resolved at the team level, the escalation process will be as follows:

Step 1: The issue will be discussed in the next project meeting.

Step 2: If unresolved, the project manager will consult with the project sponsor.

Step 3: If further escalation is required, senior management or JCUB Student Services will be involved.

4.6 Tools and Platforms

- **Project Management:** Notion (task tracking, milestone updates)
- **Communication:** WhatsApp (informal communication), Email (formal updates)
- **Surveys:** SurveyMonkey (for collecting student feedback)
- **Design Collaboration:** Figma (for wireframes, UI/UX design)
- **Development Tools:** PHP, MySQL, HTML5, CSS (for web development)

4.7 Success Metrics

Success of the communication plan will be measured through:

- Timely and transparent updates to all stakeholders.
- Positive feedback from target users (international students).
- Successful collaboration among team members.
- Effective resolution of issues and risks through early identification and communication.
- User engagement with surveys and feedback tools.

5. Team Charter

Title	WELCOME MATE
Goal	A one-stop app to guide international students through their initial days in Australia, ensuring a smooth transition and a seamless experience.
Scope	The website is designed to provide a comprehensive, user-friendly digital resource tailored specifically for JCUB students, while also being accessible to international students from other universities. The guide will include essential information on accommodation, public transportation, part-time job opportunities, and banking procedures, delivered through a website. Additionally, it will feature

	an online appointment booking system for JCUB students for personalized face-to-face assistance with counsellors. Community engagement tools, such as forums and discussion groups, giving ratings to the testimonials from senior students will be integrated to foster peer support among students.
Stakeholder	Project Sponsor (JCUB Student Services): Approve project scope and provide requirements Team Members: Execute project tasks Clients: Target users are mixed group of senior/ old international students. Provide requirements through questionnaire/ survey
Budget	Total Budget: \$10,000 Budget breakdown phase: • Research: \$2000 • Design: \$3500 • Development: \$4500
Major requirements & Deliverables	Requirements • User Registration and Profiles pages • A comprehensive Information and Resources pages • Community Features and rating/ review page • Support Services and online booking system Deliverables • Development Plan • Wireframes and UI/UX Design • Design Lo-fi, Med-Fi and Hi-Fi prototypes • Website development • User Testing plans and reports
Success factors	• Stakeholder Engagement throughout the development • Effective Communication among team members and stakeholders • Timely evaluation and feedback
Risks	• Frequent requirement changes from the stakeholders • Lack of cooperation among team members/ stakeholders

Communication Channels	Team Meetings • Schedule: Weekly status meetings every Wednesday at 3 PM. • Focus: Provide progress updates, address issues, and outline next steps. Project Management Tools • Collaborative Tool: Notion • Function: Facilitates task assignments, tracks progress, and updates milestones. • Access: All team members will have access and are expected to regularly update their tasks. Instant Messaging • Platform: WhatsApp Group • Function: For quick inquiries, urgent updates, and informal communication. Stakeholder Updates • Schedule: Weekly updates to stakeholders. • Format: Shared through presentations or reports via email or during dedicated meetings. • Content: Includes project status, key milestones, and any issues or changes
Platforms and Tools	• SurveyMonkey • Figma • MySQL • PHP • CSS • HTML5

Table 4 - Team Charter

6. Team Roles & Responsibilities

Aa Team member	≡ Role	≡ Responsibility
@Sonamm	UI/ UX Designer Front-End Developer	Create wireframes and prototypes and user flows to visualize design concepts. Develop and maintain design systems and style guides. Analyze user feedback and comment to iterate and improve designs.
@Tshering Tobgay	Project Manager Business Analyst	Develop project plan and schedule weekly meeting Get project requirements (using questionnaires, interviews, SurveyMonkey etc) Lead and motivate the project team Monitor progress and report status to stakeholders.
@Tashi	Back-end developer Front-End Developer	Develop server-side logic Manage database design and implementation User Testing Monitor and troubleshoot server and application issues, implementing fixes as needed.
@Kemith Lepcha	Back-end developer Front-End Developer Team Lead	Develop server-side logic Develop and optimize Database Coordinate team activities and manage workload distribution. Guide the team on documentation best practices, encourage contributions, and ensure alignment with project goals.

Table 5 - Team Roles and Responsibilities

7. Timeline and milestone

Week 1: Project Selection Finalized

Completion of the project selection process, confirming the scope and objectives for Welcome Mate.

Week 2: Project Charter and Team Roles Finalized

Finalization of the project charter, outlining goals, deliverables, and assigning roles and responsibilities to team members.

Week 3: Requirement Gathering Complete

Completion of requirement gathering through interviews and surveys to understand user needs and expectations.

Week 4: Prototypes Designed

Completion of initial prototypes for the Welcome Mate platform, reflecting the requirements gathered.

Week 5: First Iteration Complete

Completion of the first iteration of prototypes, incorporating initial feedback and improvements.

Week 6: Second Iteration Complete

Completion of the second iteration, refining the prototypes further based on ongoing feedback.

Week 7: Design and Development

Finalization of the design and development phase, ensuring all features are built according to specifications.

Week 8: Collect User Feedback

Gathering feedback from stakeholders and initial users to assess the platform's effectiveness and usability.

Week 9: Perform User Testing

Completion of user testing, ensuring the platform functions as intended and meets user needs.

8. Gantt Chart

The Gantt chart below provides an overview of our team's progress on the project to date. It highlights completed tasks with check marks and indicates those that are still in progress.

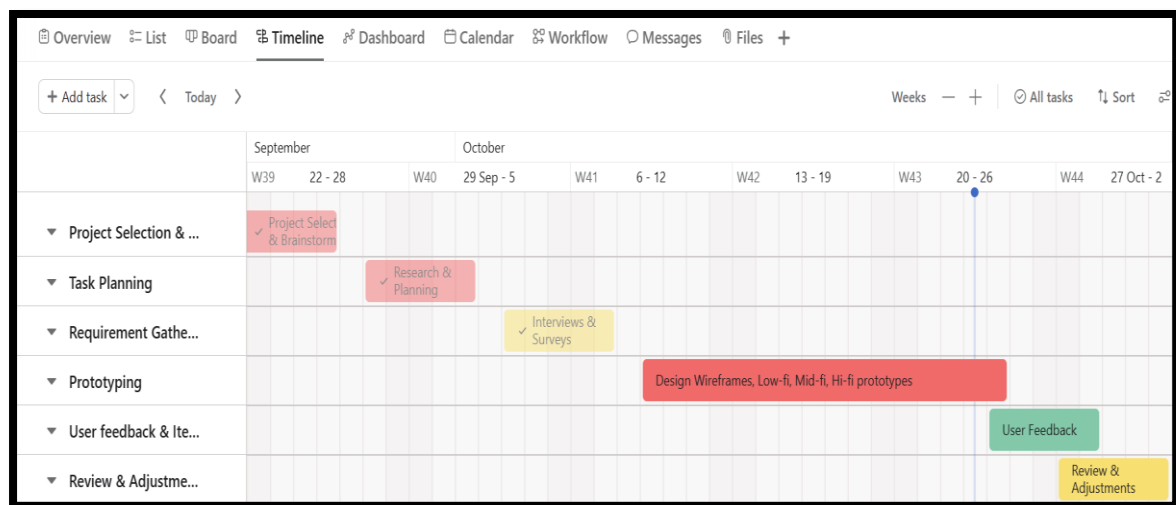


Figure 1 - Gantt Chart

9. Risk Assessment

Risk ID	Risk Definition	Likelihood (1 – 5)	Impact (1 – 5)	Risk Level (Low, Medium, High)	Mitigation Strategy
R1	Incomplete or inaccurate information in the guide	3	5	High	Regular content reviews by the admin
R2	Technical challenges with app functionality	4	5	High	Regularly conduct testing and have a responsive support team
R3	Inadequate user experience design	3	4	Medium	Constant practise on the use of figma tool so that UX designer get the confidence to prototype.
R4	Team collaboration challenges leading to miscommunication	3	3	Medium	Schedule timely meeting and get updates from each team member. Create a formal group chat using WhatsApp or any other tool
R5	Delays in getting responses from the clients.	4	5	High	Clearly outline response timelines in the initial project kick-off meeting and ensure clients understand the importance of timely feedback.
R6	Insufficient technical skills among team members may hinder the development	4	5	High	Assigning roles and responsibilities according to the team's capability and

R7	process, leading to delays, poor-quality code, and an inability to implement essential features effectively.				encourage pair programming technique.
	Insufficient user participation in system testing	3	3	Medium	Providing some incentives to the participants like certificate of appreciation, gift cards)

Table 6 - Risk Assessment

10. Requirement Gathering

Interview Question and Responses

Conducting surveys and interviews is an important process in project development. They serve as essential tools for understanding the specific needs, challenges, and expectations of the target audience.

In this project, the information gathering has been conducted in two phases.

- **Phase 1:** Gathering general information from the students through a survey.

We can identify common issues and trends among international students by gathering quantitative data through surveys, such as accommodation difficulties and employment concerns. This data provides a solid foundation for decision-making and prioritizing features in the application or website.

- **Phase 2:** Interview with the Student service, deliver the data collected from the survey and discuss how the app or the website should be brought to life.

Interviews with stakeholders, such as the student service body, allow for deeper qualitative insights. This was facilitated with open dialogue, enabling us to explore existing support

systems and gather feedback on potential solutions.

PHASE 1: Survey Questions and Responses

The Survey has been conducted using SurveyMonkey and the survey has been collected from 13 students with different cultural backgrounds and arriving at different dates to Australia.

Questions for Customers (international students)

1. What are the challenges that you face upon arrival?

- Accommodation
- Health (mental or Physical)
- Transportation
- Casual Job
- Banking and other system

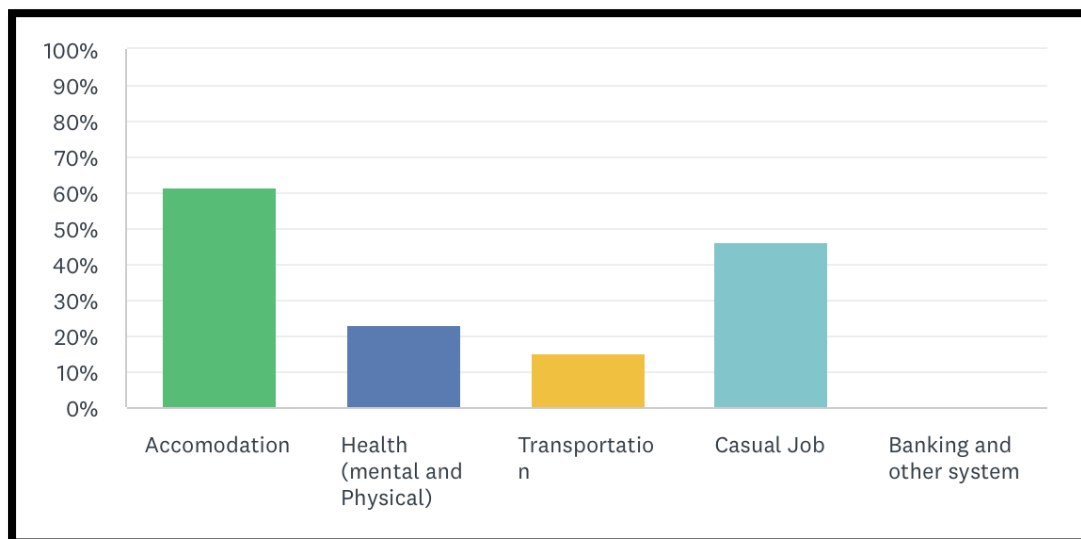


Figure 2 - Issues faced by International students

The figure illustrates different types of issues faced by international students, the most common are accommodation and finding a job. Which accounts to around 60% and 48%.

2. What Information would have been most helpful to you upon arriving in Australia?

Responses

All the students shared different insights on types of information that could have helped them during their arrival. Following are the Annex of the responses collected from the student through the survey.

- Respondent 1: *“Easy access to rent a house without showing payslip”*.
- Respondent 2: *“Getting rental history to find a house”*.
- Respondent 3: *“Australian rules and regulations”*.
- Respondent 4: *“Mostly accommodation related”*
- Respondent 5: *“About the employment system”*
- Respondent 6: *“How to get a job...”*
- Respondent 7: *“Accommodation and job application services”*
- Respondent 8: *“Finding jobs”*
- Respondent 9: *“Accommodation”*
- Respondent 10: *“Information about the career and jobs that we can start working on after reaching here”*.
- Respondent 11: *“Finding accommodation”*
- Respondent 12: *“Health service”*
- Respondent 13: *“Ideas on looking for jobs”*

Upon analysing the above responses, many students commented on the information regarding the accommodation and few on finding a job.

3. What resources or services would have made your transition easier?

- Accommodation
- Health (mental or physical)
- Navigation
- Transportation
- Finding a Casual Job

Responses and analysis

ANSWER CHOICES	RESPONSES	
▼ Accomodation	30.77%	4
▼ Health (mental or Physical)	15.38%	2
▼ Navigation	15.38%	2
▼ Transportation	38.46%	5
▼ Finding a Casual Job	46.15%	6
Total Respondents: 13		

Figure 3 - Responses and analysis

4. Did you feel supported by the university in addressing these concerns?

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Neither agree nor disagree
- Disagree
- Strongly disagree

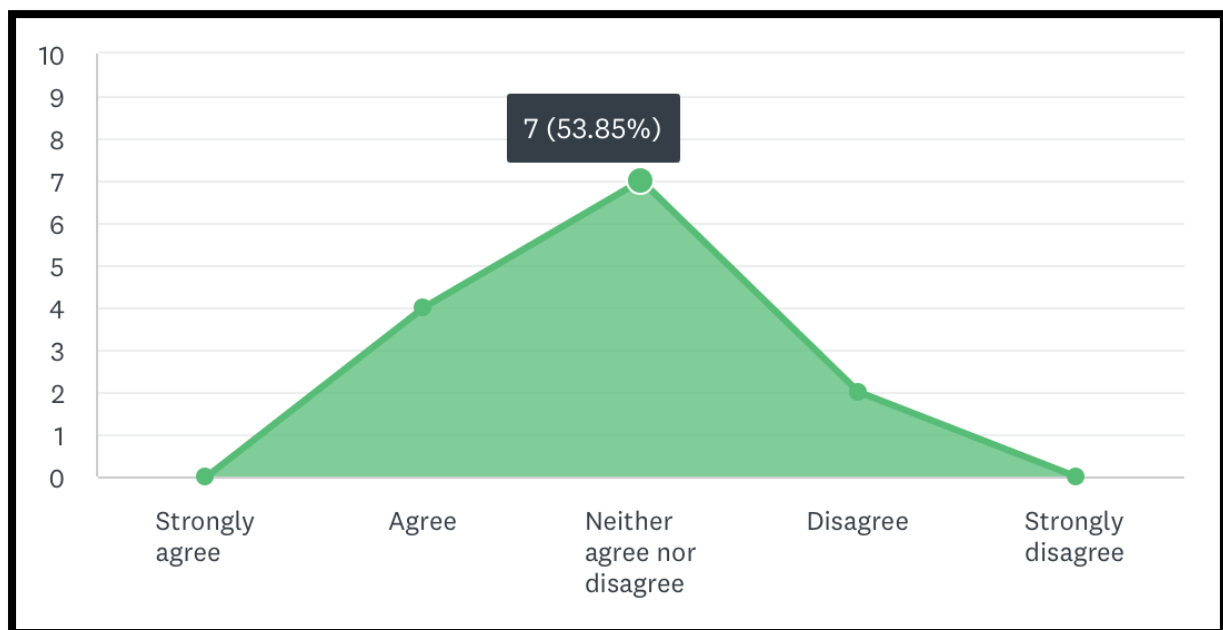


Figure 4 - University Support Satisfaction Survey

5. How do you think the university should support you in your transition?

- Respondent 1: *“providing frequent face-to-face interaction and follow-up”*
- Respondent 2: *“Help us with proper guidance and support with credentials for the house”*
- Respondent 3: *“Accommodation and transportation”*
- Respondent 4: *“I didn’t ask for any support”*
- Respondent 5: *“would be helpful we there are someone who can help us in person”*
- Respondent 6: *“By giving us jobs and ideas about one”*
- Respondent 7: *“Conducting meetings with international students frequently”*
- Respondent 8: *“inform about the possibilities of finding a job and how to find a Casual Job”*
- Respondent 9: *“No comments”*
- Respondent 10: *“Understanding common issues and helping them resolve it”*
- Respondent 11: *“The University is doing its best”*
- Respondent 12: *“Follow up on the student’s situation”*
- Respondent 13: *“conduct frequent orientation and programs”*

6. Have you used any service-providing apps before that helped you with the issues mentioned above? If so, what did you like or dislike about them?

- All 13 individuals responded that they have not used any app or website that helped with the issues mentioned.

7. What features would you find most helpful in a service-providing platform, like a mobile application or a website?

- Respondent 1: *“People reference”*
- Respondent 2: *“Finding an assistant or proper guidance”*
- Respondent 3: *“something like Facebook marketplace”*
- Respondent 4: *“Recommendation for housing”*
- Respondent 5: *“Mobile application”*

- Respondent 6: *“Information regarding lifestyle for international students”*
- Respondent 7: *“chat”*
- Respondent 8: *“Guidance”*
- Respondent 9: *“Convenient to use at any time”*
- Respondent 10: *“Mobile application”*
- Respondent 11: *“we can directly chat or talk with the service provider”*
- Respondent 12: *“Commonwealth app”*
- Respondent 13: *“if they can carry forward our credentials”*

8. Are there any cultural challenges you might face that an application, or a website could help resolve?

- Also, in the case of cultural challenges, almost all the respondents commented that they don't face many cultural issues. Except for one respondent, 'it is difficult to understand the social norms and regulations of Australia'

9. Would you be open to providing feedback? If yes, how would you like to provide the feedback?

- Message
- Survey rating
- Pon website
- Written feedback

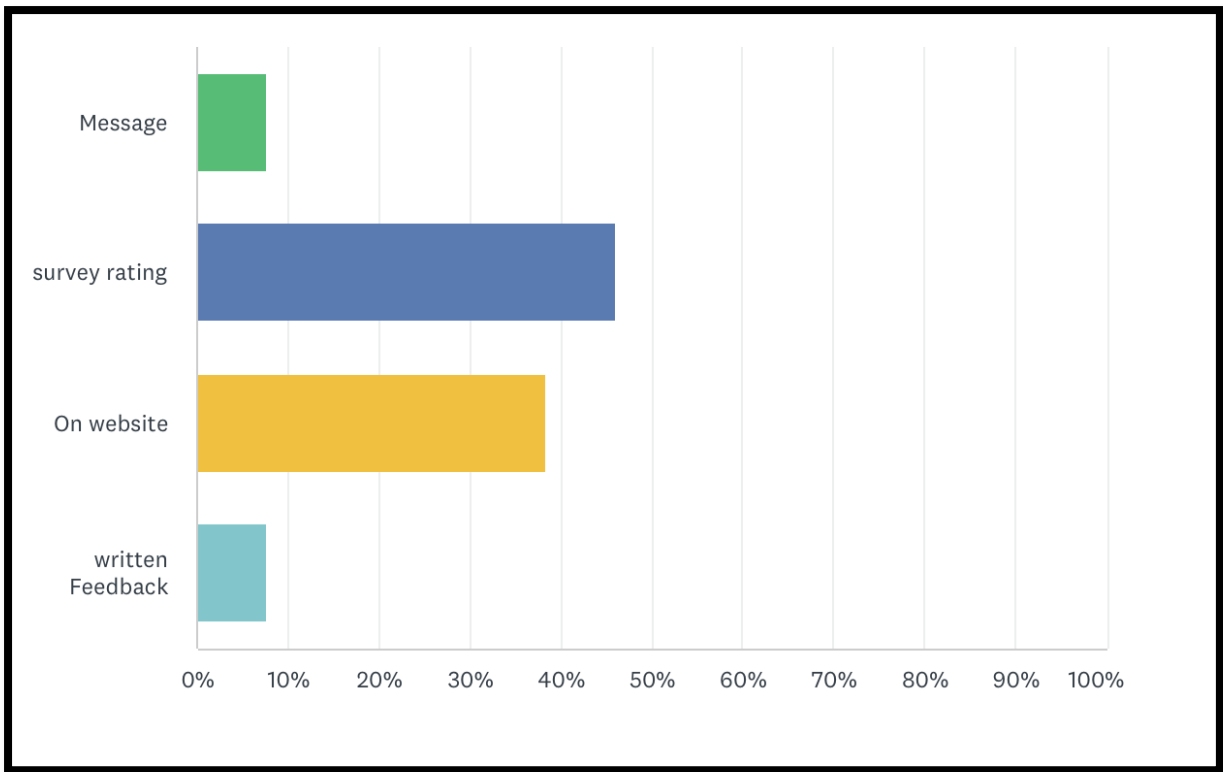


Figure 5 - Preferred Feedback Methods

PHASE 2: Interview with Student service body.

An open conversation with up to five question was conducted with the student service body of JCUB. Following is the synopsis of the conversation.

1. What support services do you currently offer to international students regarding accommodation and employment?

Response: “We don’t have a team dedicated to assisting students with finding accommodation. However, we provide resources like lists of rental agencies and tips on navigating the housing market. For employment, we offer workshops on resume writing and interview skills, and we have a job board where students can find local job listings through Joblinx.”

2. Are you aware of the significant concerns international students have regarding accommodation and finding jobs? What steps have you taken to address these issues?

Response, “Yes, we’ve noticed a growing trend in concerns around accommodation, especially with the rising rental prices. It’s been difficult for many students. We’re constantly looking for ways to improve our services, we could explore partnerships with local real estate agencies to provide students with references or even a rental history document.”

3. What challenges does the university face in providing adequate resources for international students?

Response. “One of our main challenges is communication. We have a lot of services available, but getting the word out to students can be difficult. Many international students are overwhelmed with the transition and might not know where to start looking for help.”

4. Do you think having a dedicated app or website could streamline access to these resources? What features do you think would be most beneficial?

Response, “I think a centralized platform where students can find information about housing, job opportunities, and university resources would be incredibly useful. If it included a chat function or forum for students to ask questions and connect with each other, that could help foster a community as well.”

5. How do you currently gather feedback from international students, and how can this process be improved?

Response, “Right now, we mainly use surveys at the end of the semester, but I think we could do more. Perhaps setting up regular focus groups or feedback sessions would allow us to gather more real-time insights. Engaging with students more frequently would help us stay informed about their evolving needs.”

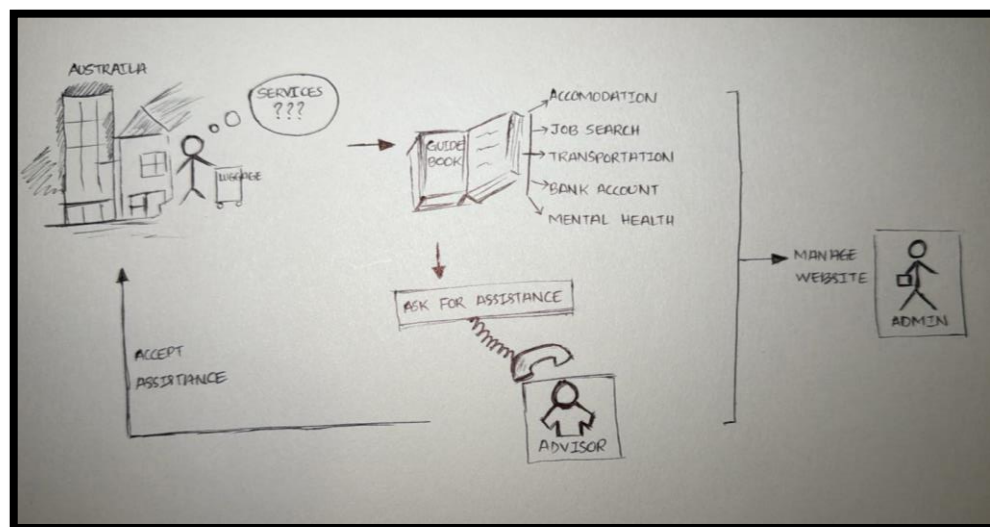
Limitation

Due to the limitation on time and resources the sample size was limited to 20 individuals participating in the survey however, only 13 responded to the survey, this which may lead to limited decision-making ability. The sample may not be able to represent the entire population of the international student

The decision and the response from the interview with the Student Service Body is not finalised. Communication is a continuous process, and the information gathered will be documented on a regular basis's and even during the development phase.

11. System Metaphor

The system metaphor for Welcome Mate below illustrates the journey of a newly arrived international student in need of essential services. A book represents the website, serving as the gateway to accessing various resources. Students can request assistance, which can be booked online. Once the request is approved by the admin, a buddy will be assigned to provide support. Additionally, the system efficiently manages the website's database, ensuring that all information and services are organized and easily accessible.



This metaphor emphasizes Welcome Mate's role in facilitating a smooth transition for international student.

Figure 6 - System Metaphor

12. Affinity Map

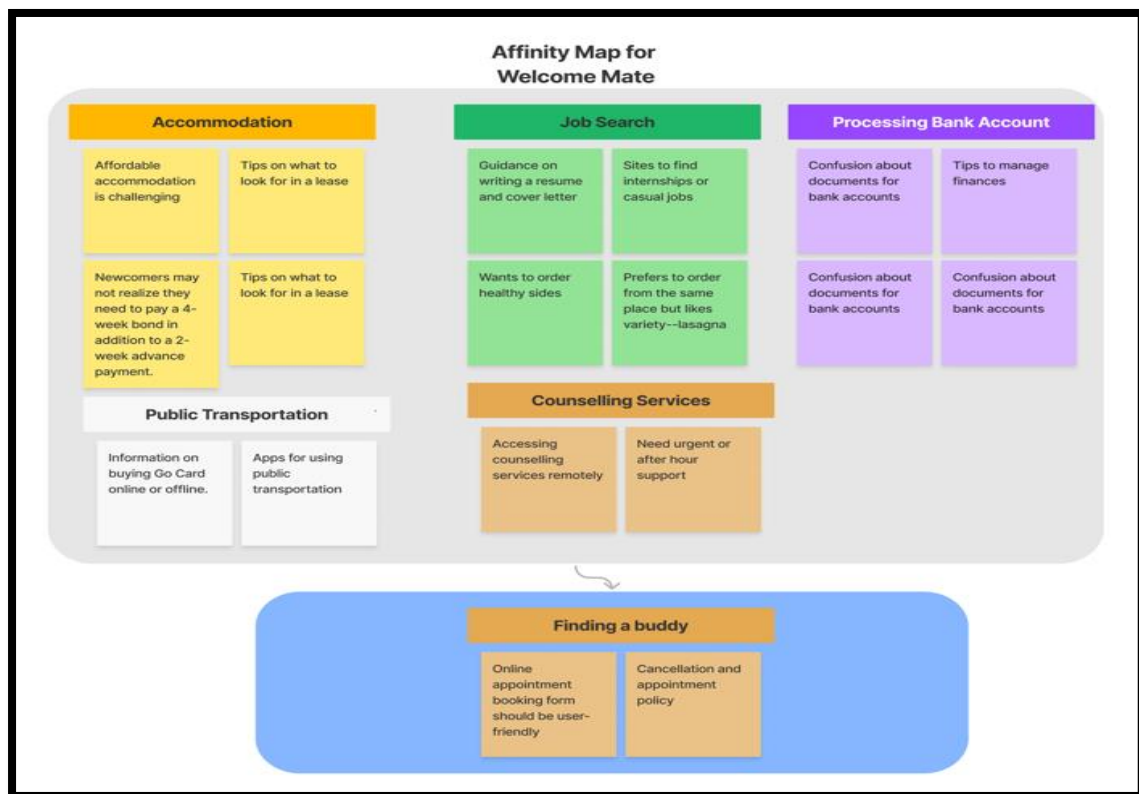


Figure 7 - Affinity map

13. Empathy map

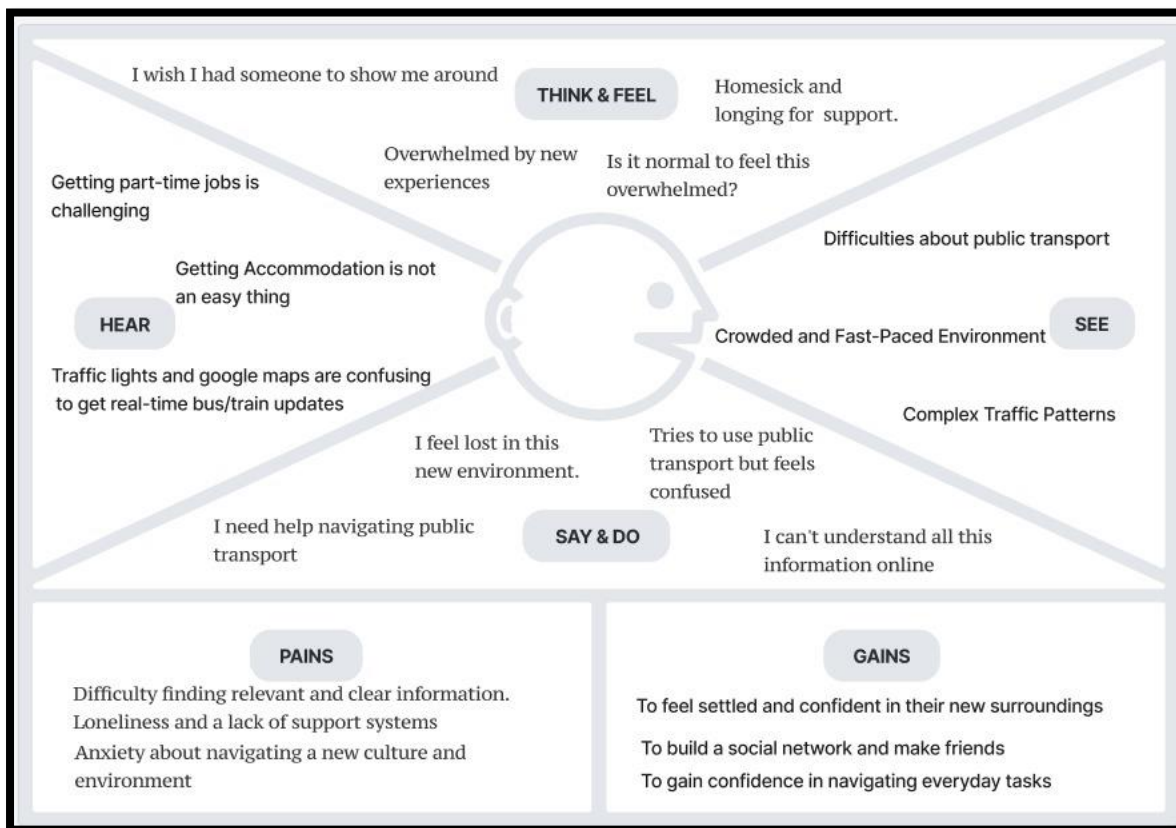


Figure 8 - Empathy map

14. Features and Functionalities

I. Homepage Design:

- Body section
 - Welcome Message: A friendly, welcoming message that explains the app's purpose.
 - A "Get Started" button to direct users to Signup/ Sign in.
- Side Navigation Bar:
 - Display service where different services provided are listed, such as:
 - Finding Accommodation
 - Searching for jobs
 - Opening a Bank Account
 - Navigating Public Transport
 - Counselling Services

- **Success story section:** It displays a series of success stories or positive experiences of individuals who has used this platform.
- ‘Why use our website?’ section
- **Footer:** Include links for "About Us," "Contact," "FAQ," and social media links.

II. Login and Sign-Up pages

- Add "Login" and "Sign Up" buttons in the top-right corner of the tittle bar for easy access.
- When a user is logged in, provide for a button for profile settings and Logout options.
Login Page:
- Fields: Email/Username and Password input fields.
- Buttons:
 - "Login" button for submitting the credentials.
 - "Forgot Password?" link for password recovery.
 - Option to "Login with Google" or other social media if you want social login integration.
 - New to the Platform? - A "Sign Up" link to redirect new users to the registration page.

III. Core Functionalities

The "**Welcome Mate**" website will focus on five crucial topics that are essential for newcomers to Australia, ensuring they receive the support and information they need as they settle in:

a. Accommodation

Functionality: Users can explore various accommodation options, including Uni Lodge, shared, and rented apartments.

Features:

- Search filters (price range, location, type).
- Links to reliable real estate platforms.
- Tips on signing leases and understanding rental agreements.

b. Job Search

Functionality: A dedicated section for job hunting resources, including local job boards and application tips.

Features:

- Listings of part-time job opportunities suitable for international students.
- Resume and cover letter templates.
- Guides on work rights and visa regulations.

c. Processing Bank Account

Functionality: Information on setting up a bank account in Australia, including necessary documentation and processes.

Features:

- Step-by-step guides for various banks.
- Comparison of banking options (fees, services).
- Tips on managing finances as a student.

d. Public Transportation

Functionality: Comprehensive information on navigating public transportation systems in major cities. Upon clicking Transportation tab, users will be navigated to a page which will have options like Go Card and Navigation using Maps.

Features:

- Link to apply for Go card online and apply student concession on Go card
- Navigation using maps (myTranslink, Google maps, apple maps)

Counselling Services

Functionality: Resources and support for mental health and well-being.

Features:

- Information on available counselling services and hotlines.
- Tips for managing stress and homesickness.
- Links to workshops and community support groups.

Online Booking System

Users seeking assistance with accommodation, bank card processing, or obtaining a Go card for public transportation can schedule an appointment to get a buddy.

Functionality: There will be a dedicated section for users to book an appointment. Once approved, they will receive a notification with the meeting details, including the time and location.

15. User Stories

User stories are one of the main elements in Agile Software Development Process that help teams understand the needs and goals of their users. It acts like a bridge between a technical requirements and real needs of a system user.

The figure below illustrates various user requirements presented as stories, highlighting how these narratives guide development efforts. However, they can evolve over time based on user feedback and changing requirements, allowing teams to adapt quickly.



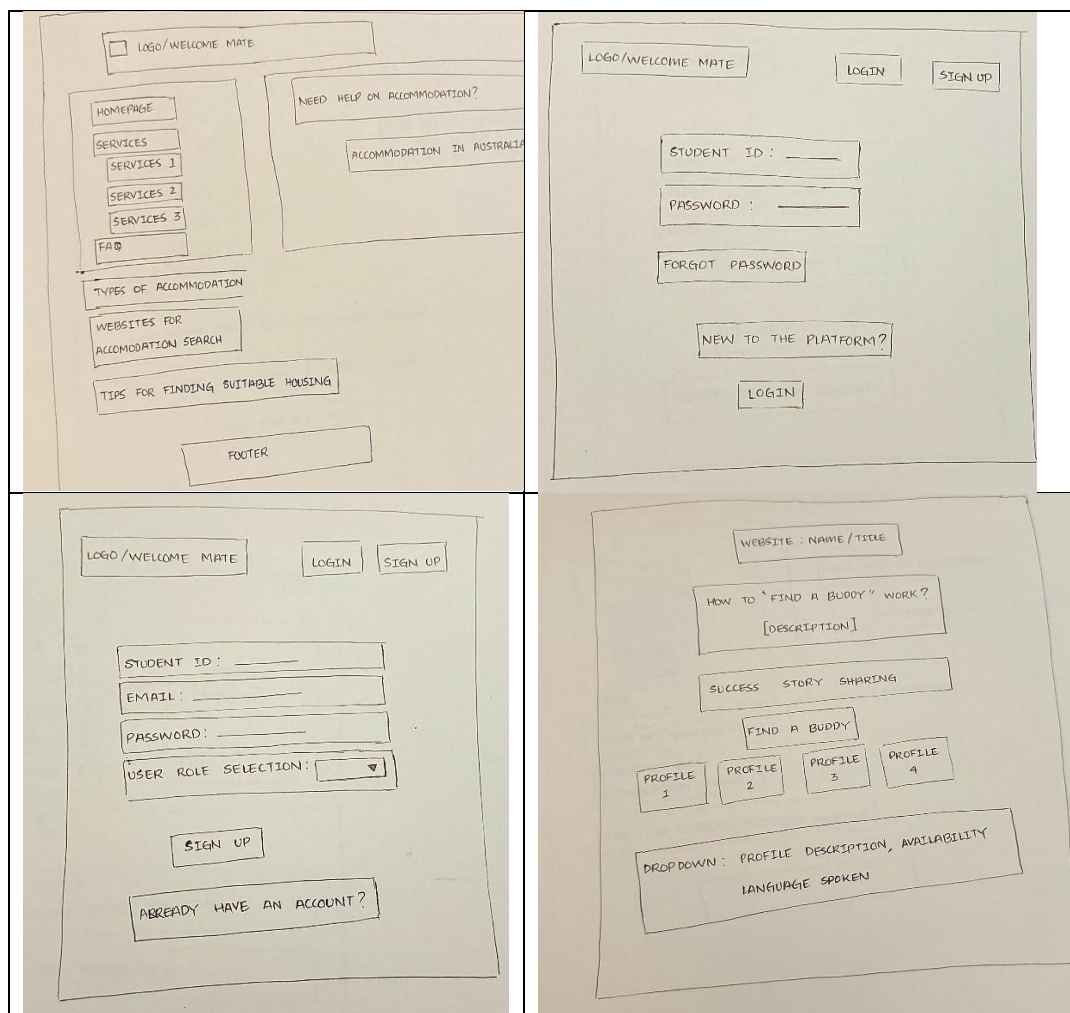
Figure 9 - User Stories

16. Prototype Planning

Iterative Development process

The development of the "Welcome Mate" prototype followed an iterative process focused on user feedback and collaborative discussions. This careful refinement ensured the prototype met the diverse needs, preferences, and challenges of the target audience. Each iteration was guided by insights gained from thorough user testing, valuable feedback, and ongoing collaboration among team members. The following shows UI for each iteration:

- Initial Iteration



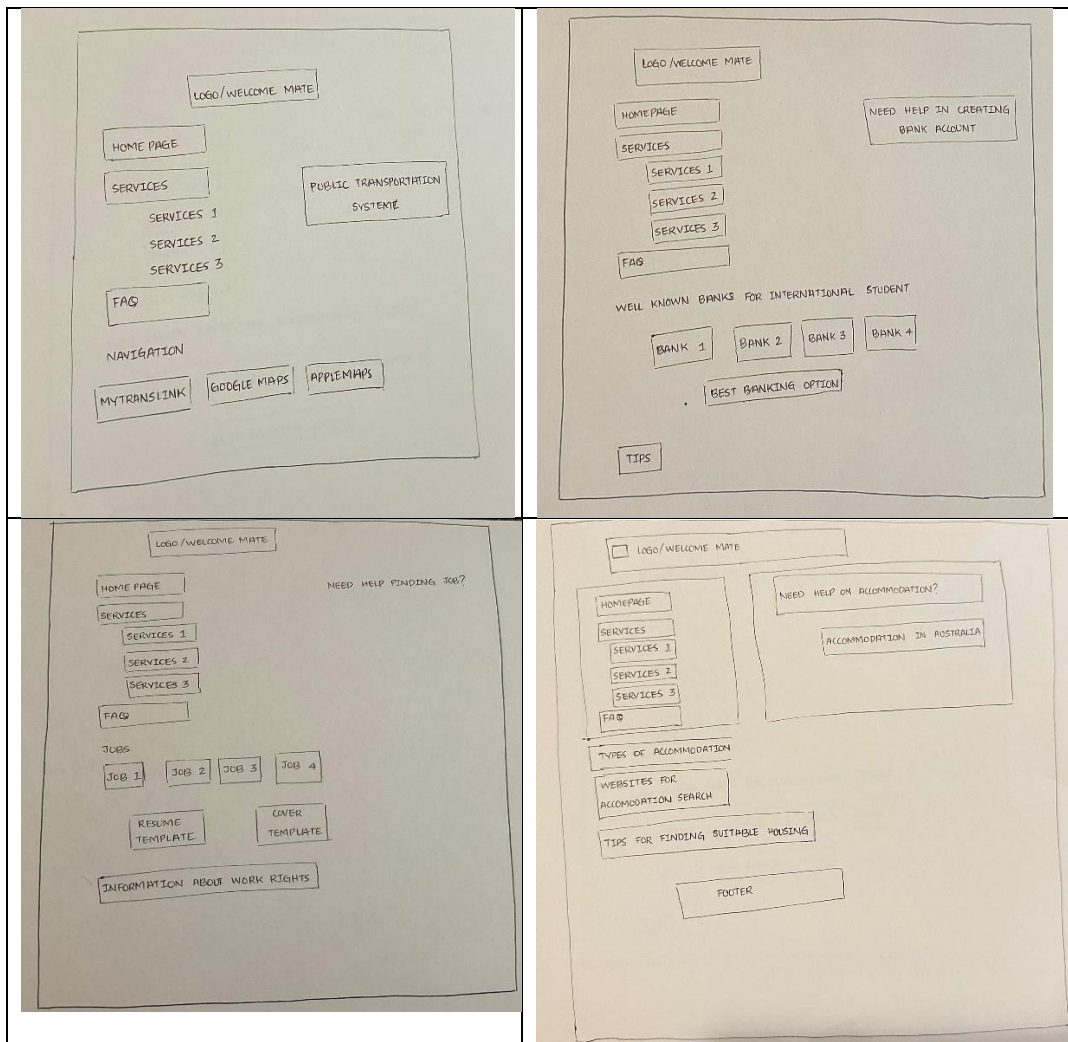


Figure 10 - Low-fi of the website pages

- Second Iteration: The following *figures 12 to 19* are the Mid-fi prototypes for the website after getting feedback and suggestions from the target users and the teams.

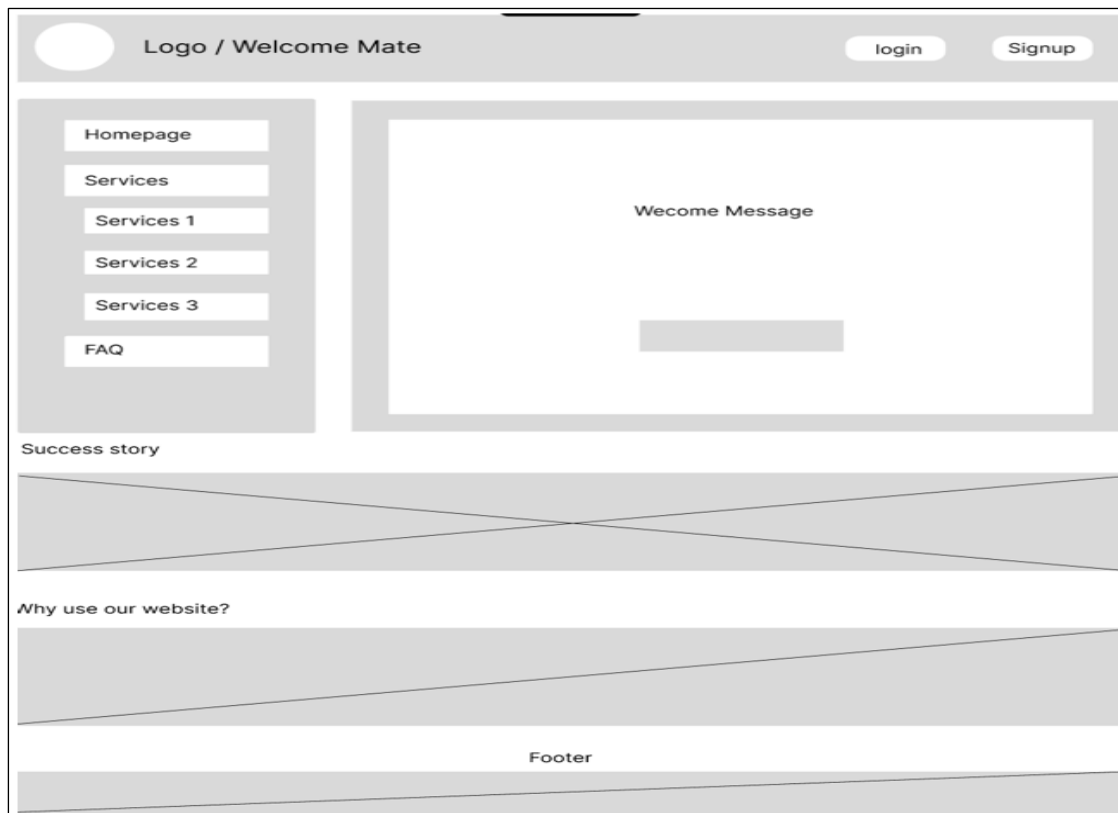


Figure 11 - Mid-fi Home Page

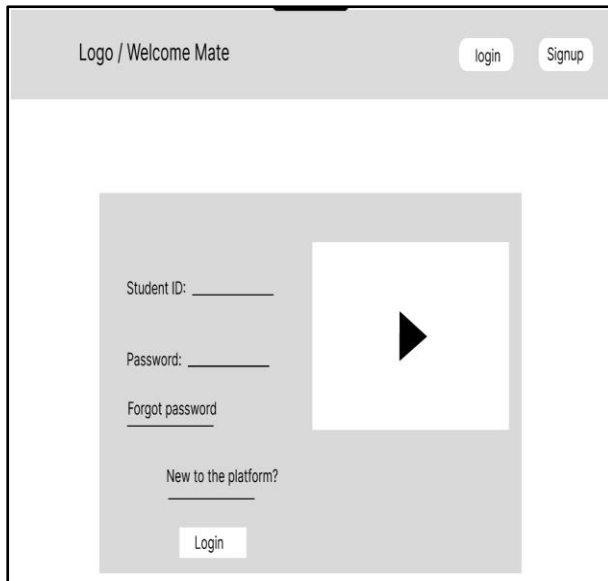


Figure 13 - Mid-fi Login page

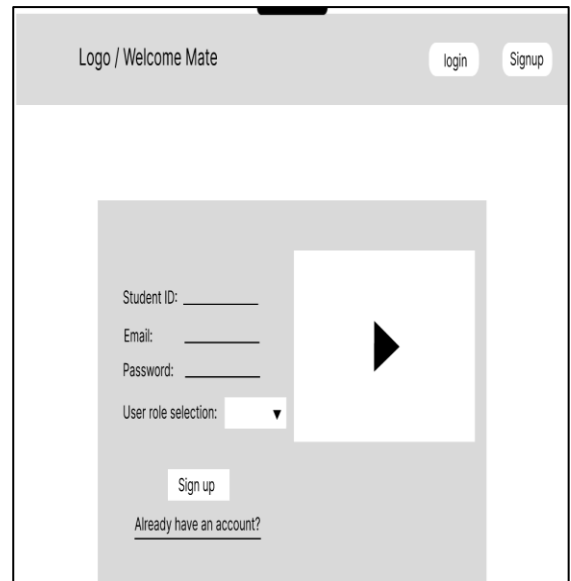


Figure 12 - Mid-fi Sign up page

This is a success message page once you create an account.

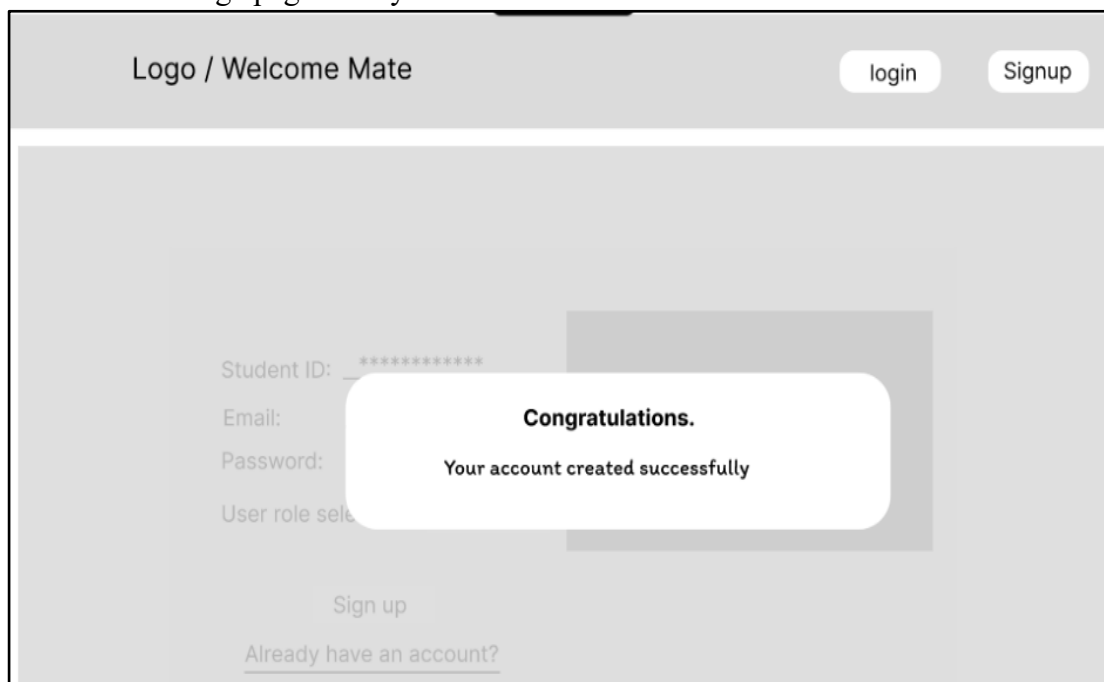


Figure 14 - Mid-fi account success page

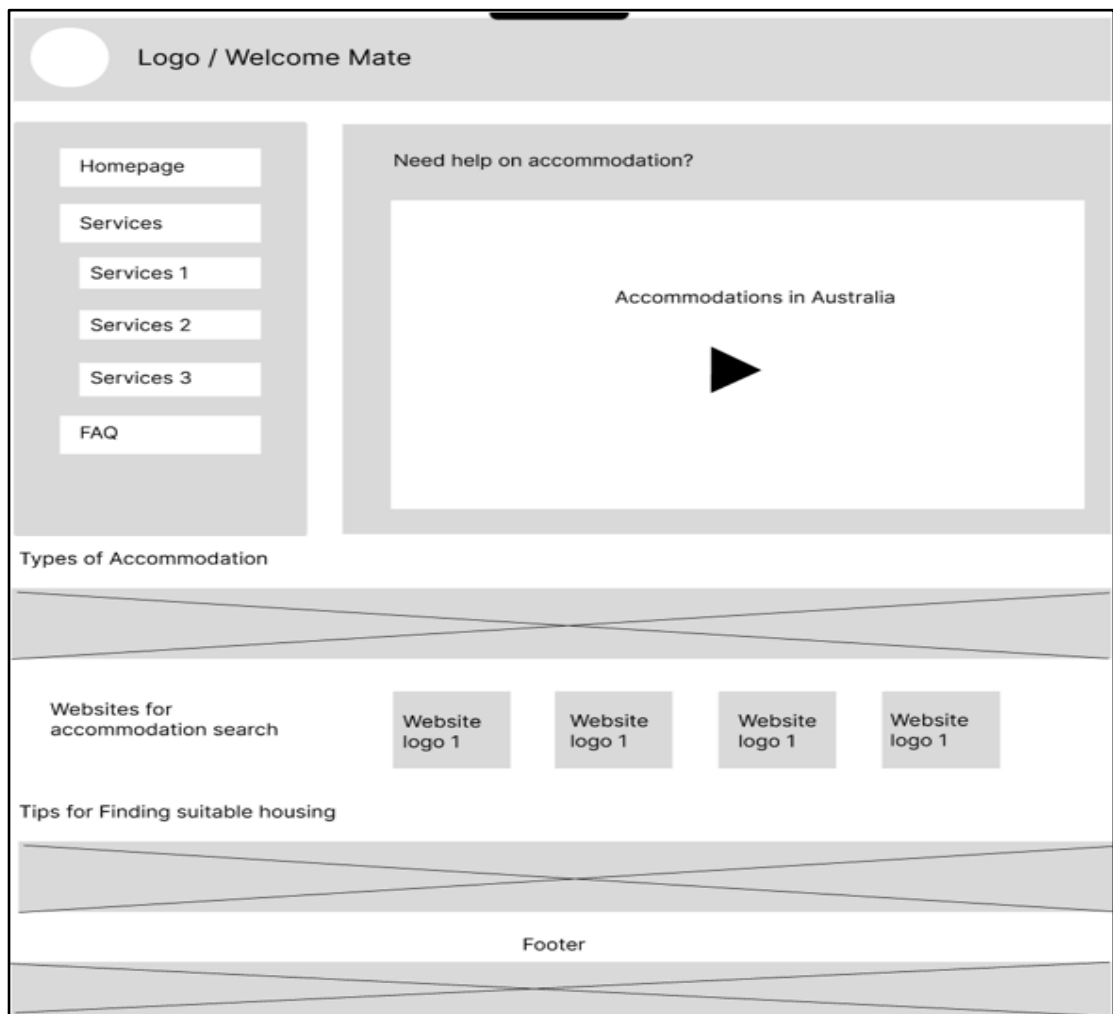


Figure 15 - Mid-fi Searching Accommodation Page

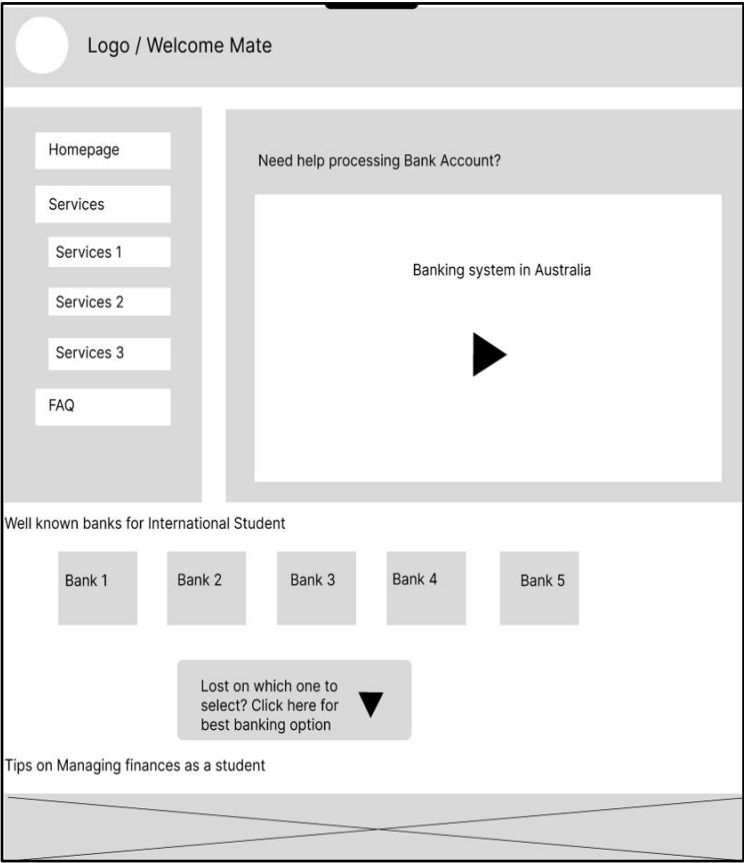


Figure 17 - Find suitable banks page

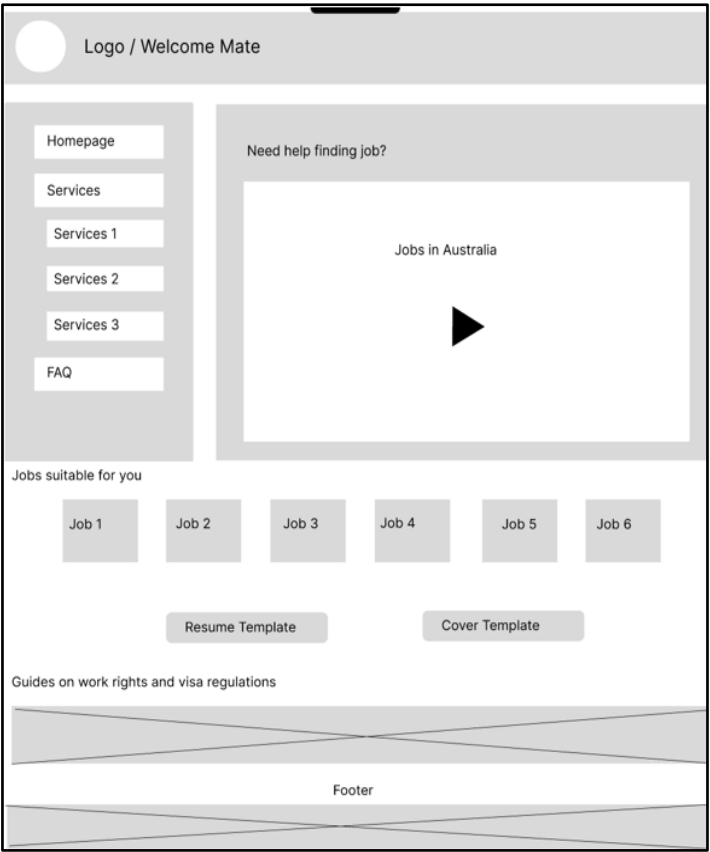


Figure 16 - Finding Job Page

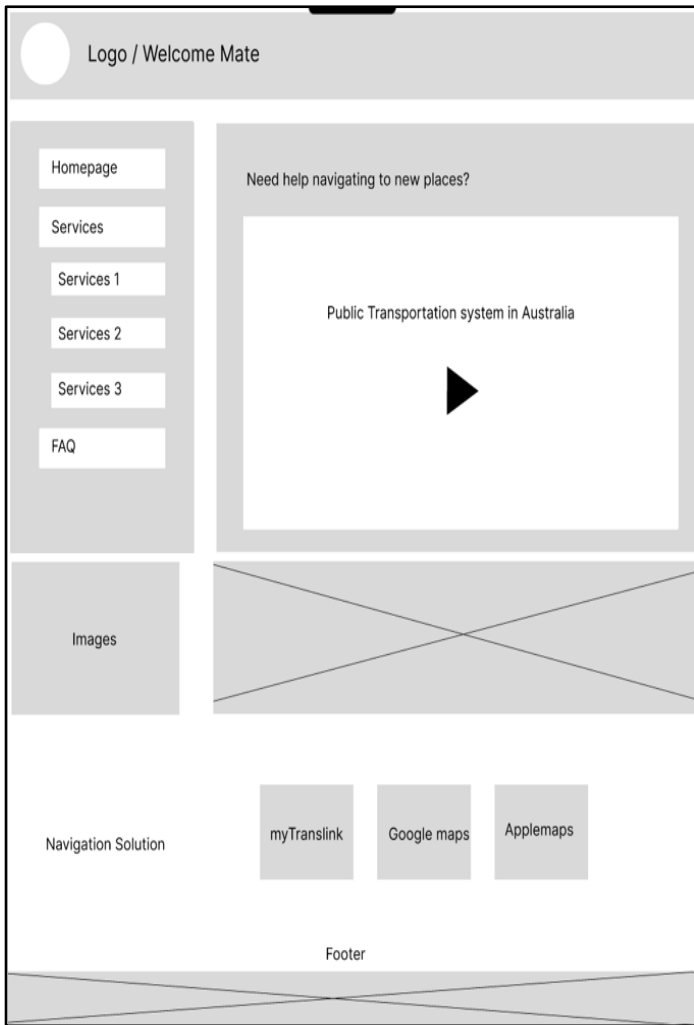


Figure 19 - Transportation page

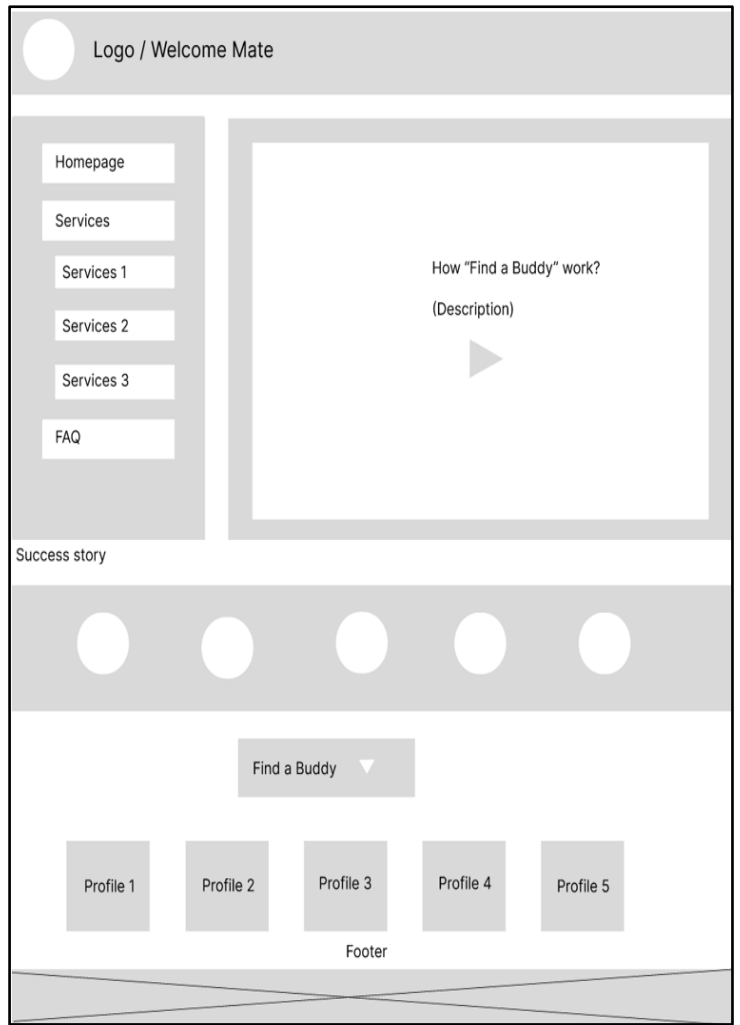


Figure 18 - Find a buddy page

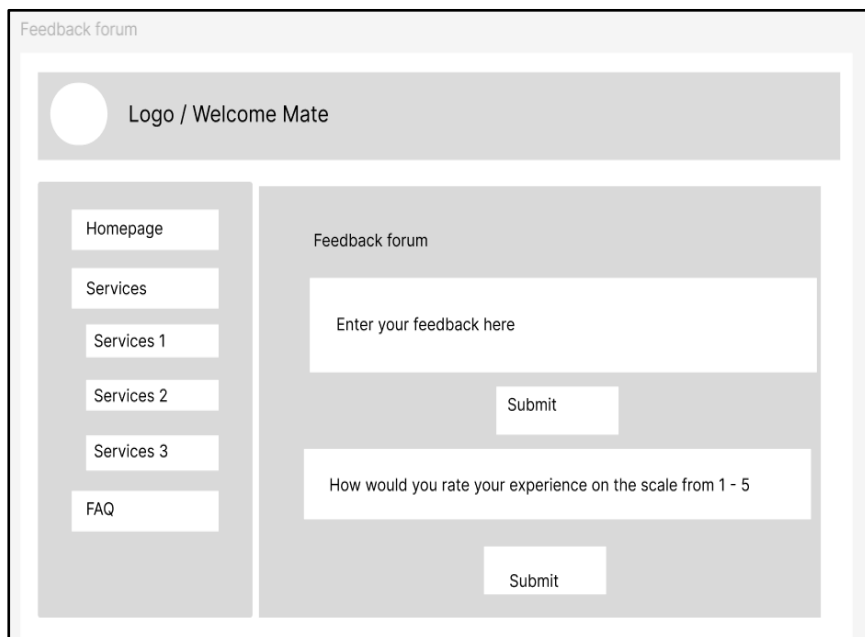


Figure 20- Feedback forum

Final Iteration:

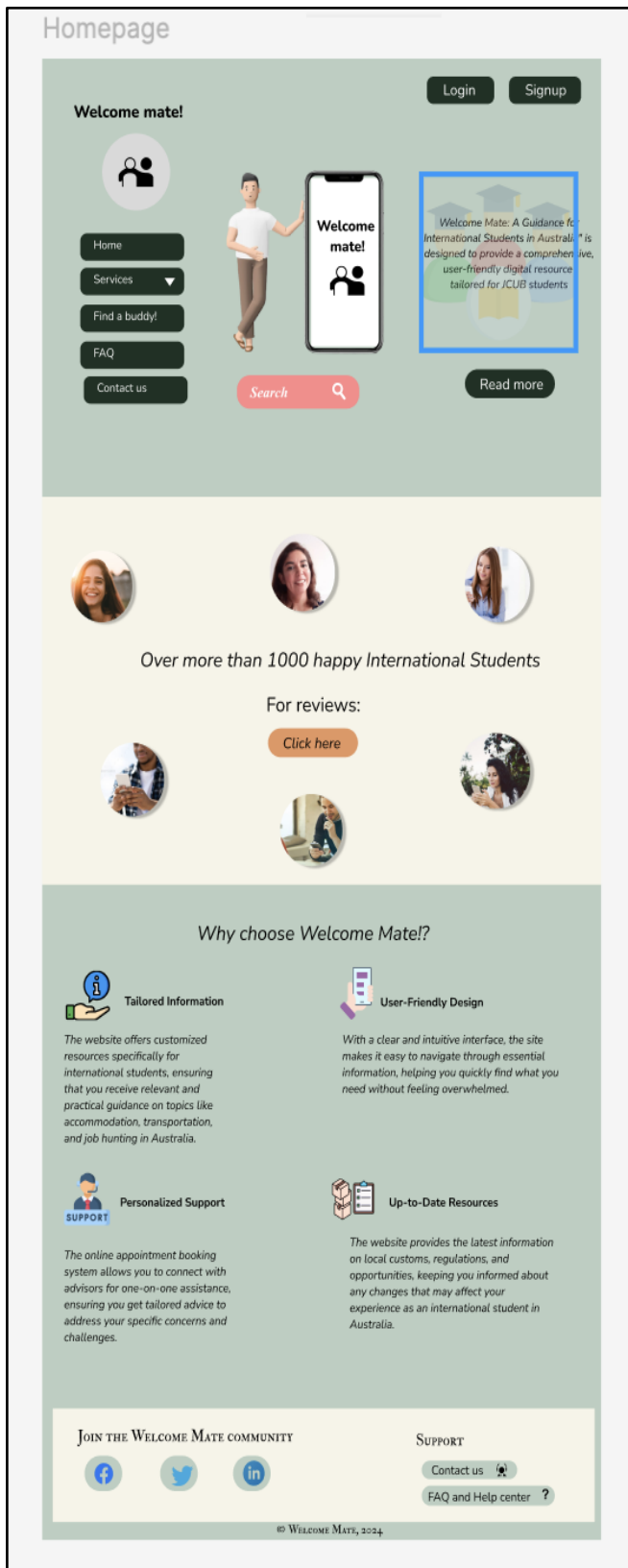


Figure 22- Hi-fi Homepage

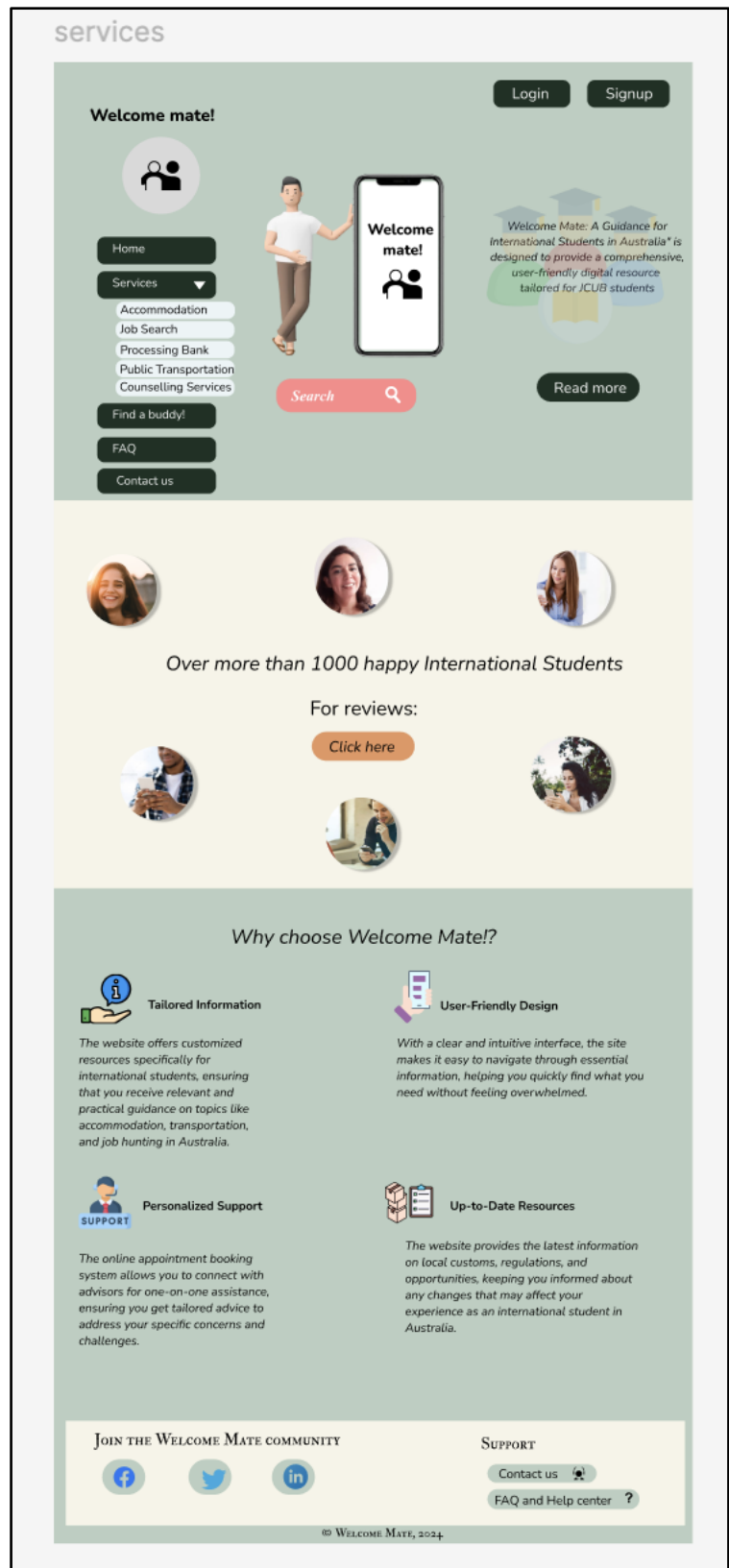


Figure 21 - Hi-fi services page

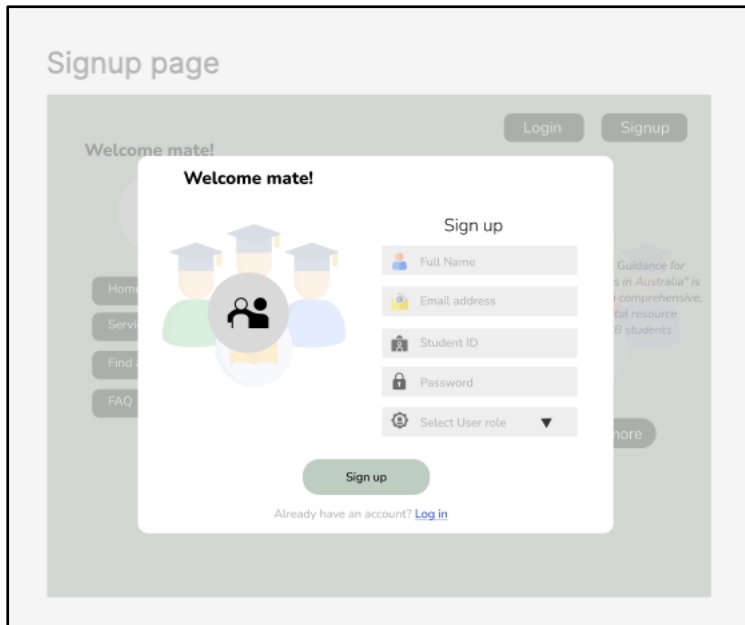


Figure 23 - Hi-fi signup page

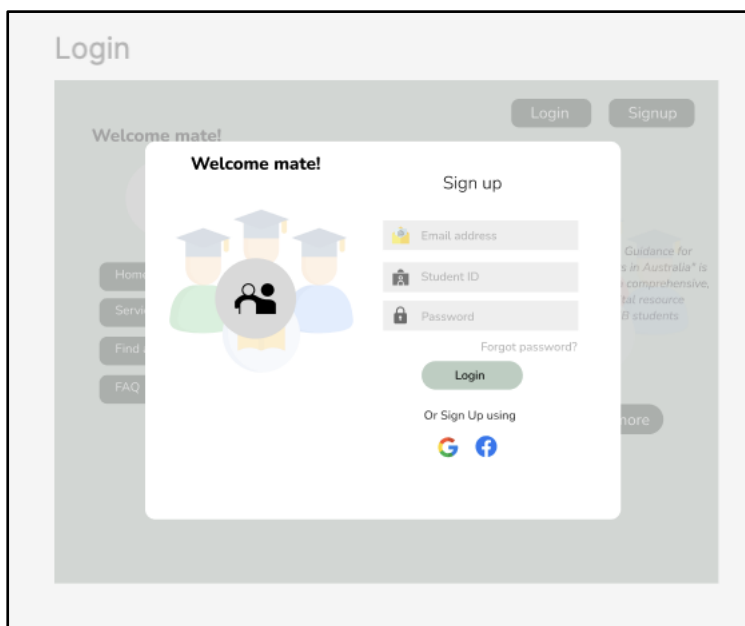


Figure 24 - Hi-fi Login page

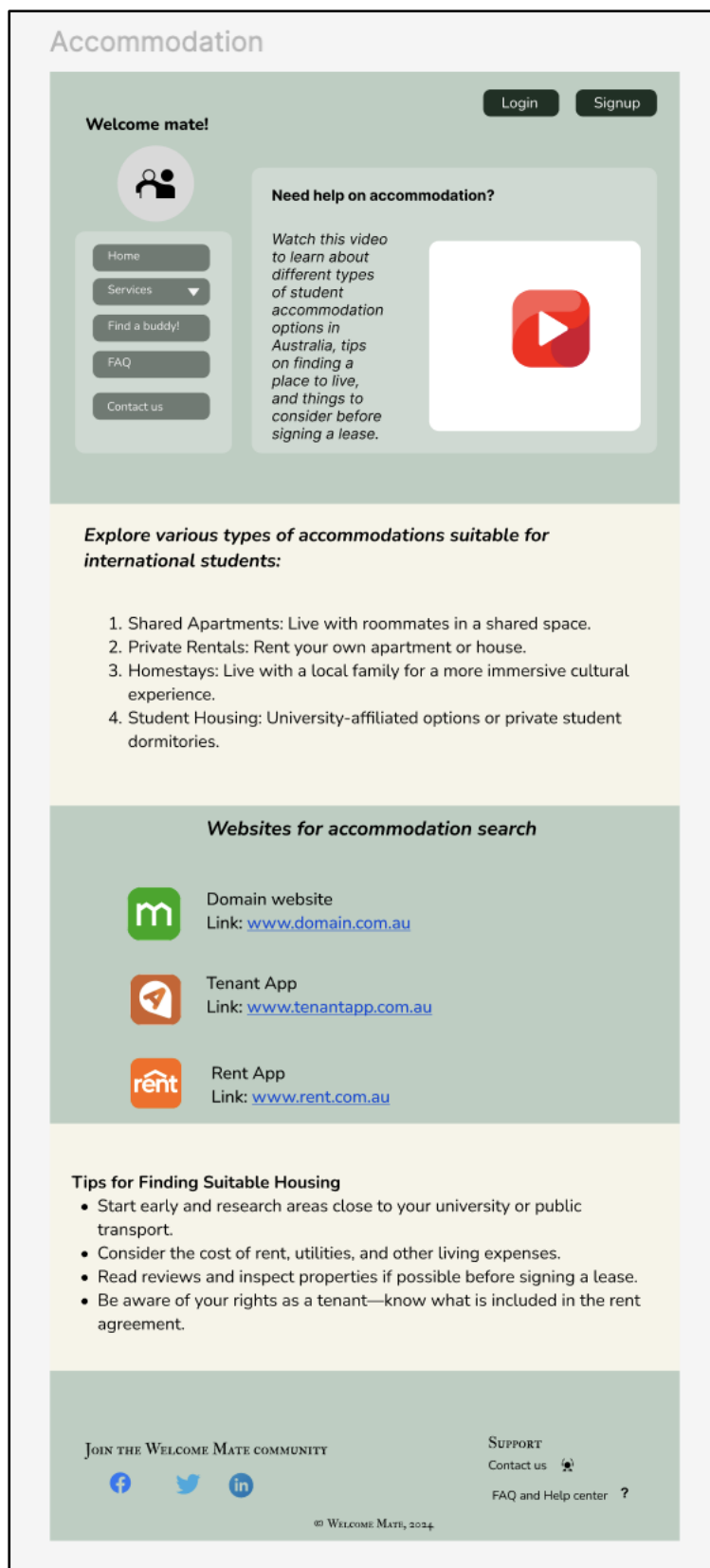


Figure 25 – Hi-fi Accommodation page

Currently, we are halfway through building the high-fidelity (hifi) prototype. While significant progress has been made, there are limitations, particularly in terms of time constraints and the challenge of fully integrating customer feedback into the hifi at this stage. The iterative nature of XP requires continuous refinement, but with the project timeline, we may need to prioritize certain features and testing rounds, which could limit the depth of design iterations. Nevertheless, we remain on track, using the feedback we've gathered to guide the upcoming stages of the prototype and iteration planning.

17. Customer Feedback

One of the main challenges the team faced was figuring out how users would navigate all these different services without feeling overwhelmed. There were also some concerns about how well the platform's search features would work and whether it would be responsive on different devices like smartphones and tablets.

Prototype Issues and Key Design Areas

1. Navigation and Too Much Information

The left sidebar on the platform organizes services like the homepage, finding a buddy, job search, and more. A big concern was whether having so many options would confuse users or make them feel lost.

Observations:

Problem Identified	Customer Feedback
When users first land on the homepage, they might feel overwhelmed by the number of options available.	Customers suggested adding a clearer welcome message to help orient users. They also thought that important features, such as "Find a Buddy," should be highlighted more prominently, either with a bigger button or a direct link on the homepage.

2. Interactive Elements

The platform includes interactive features like video guides (for example, an accommodation tutorial) and search tools for jobs and housing. The concern was whether these interactive features would work well across different devices, or if they would slow down the page.

Observations:

Problem Identified	Customer Feedback
Too many videos or interactive elements could make the page slower, especially for mobile users, and might confuse students.	Users appreciated the videos but warned that too many large interactive elements could slow the page down, especially on mobile devices. The team realized they needed to balance these elements with performance.

3. Finding a Buddy

The "Find a Buddy" page allows students to book appointments with volunteers and advisors. The challenge was whether students would understand how to choose an advisor based on their availability or expertise.

Observations:

Problem Found	Customer Feedback
Students might not easily understand which advisor to choose without more detailed profiles.	Customers wanted more information about each advisor's expertise and clearer availability times, so they could choose the right person more confidently.

4. Notification and Reminders System: A system to notify students about upcoming advisor meetings, new job postings, or important deadlines was not yet included in the prototype. This missing feature could reduce engagement if users miss opportunities or appointments.

Observations:

Problem found	Customer Feedback
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There was no visible notification system to remind users about tasks or events they've signed up for.	Customers suggested adding a notification system via email or in-app alerts. This would help users stay on track with their meetings, job applications, or other important events, improving overall user experience.
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5. **User Feedback and Ratings System:** The platform lacks a mechanism for users to provide feedback on services like accommodation options, advisor interactions, or job search results. Implementing a rating or review system could help future users make better-informed decisions.

Observations:

Problem found	Customer Feedback
The prototype didn't include a way for students to rate or review the advisors they met with or the accommodations they used.	Users suggested adding a feedback system where they could leave ratings and reviews for accommodations, advisors, or even the overall experience with the platform. This would provide valuable insights for both the platform administrators and future users, fostering a more interactive community.

Key Insights and Feedback

After showing the prototype to customers, the team gathered several key insights:

1. **User Orientation:** Customers felt the homepage needed a clearer introduction that explained the platform's key features, such as accommodation search and finding an advisor. This would help users feel more comfortable navigating the site.
2. **Mobile Responsiveness:** While the design was well-received, there were concerns about how well the platform would perform on mobile devices, as many students would be accessing it on smartphones.

3. **Balancing Interactive Elements:** Customers liked the interactive tools like video tutorials but stressed the importance of keeping the page fast and simple. Too many large media elements could slow the platform down, especially for users with slower internet connections.
4. **Streamlining the Sign-up Process:** Adding third-party login options (like Google or Facebook) and providing clearer guidelines for password creation were important steps for making the sign-up process more user-friendly.

18. Expectations for the First XP Iteration Planning Meeting

In our first XP iteration planning meeting, our primary focus will be to establish a detailed plan for the development of the Welcome Mate website. This website is designed to provide comprehensive support for new international students arriving in Australia by helping them navigate key aspects of settling into their new environment, such as finding accommodation, setting up bank accounts, accessing transport options, and completing essential tasks like obtaining SIM cards and searching part-time jobs. The meeting will begin by revisiting and confirming the user stories derived from our interviews with stakeholders to ensure the team has a shared understanding of the project's immediate priorities. These user stories outline the core features students need upon arrival, including a home screen with easy navigation to accommodation search, banking guidance, transportation details, and a checklist of essential post-arrival tasks. Each of these features is essential for helping students manage the challenges of relocating to a new country.

The team will prioritize the development of these features, breaking them down into smaller tasks that can be accomplished within a single iteration. For example, creating the app's navigation structure and basic UI for the accommodation search and checklist will be key initial tasks. Accommodation listings will be linked to a simple backend database, while the banking guide will offer an overview of setting up accounts with popular banks in Australia. We will assign specific tasks to team members based on their expertise, ensuring a balanced distribution of work. We will estimate the effort required for each task, allowing the team to establish realistic timelines. This approach ensures that we can deliver the most crucial features first

while allowing flexibility for ongoing feedback and improvement throughout the development process.

Effective collaboration and communication will be a critical aspect of the first iteration. The team will agree on using daily stand-ups to discuss progress, address any issues, and ensure that everyone remains aligned on priorities. To keep track of progress, we will use tools like notion to monitor tasks, deadlines, and dependencies. The team will also regularly review the feedback gained from presenting the UX prototype to the customer. During the prototype presentation, we will gather valuable insights on how users interact with the app, focusing on areas such as ease of navigation, intuitiveness of features, and overall user experience. The feedback will guide further design decisions and help the team refine the app's features.

Additionally, we will identify potential risks that could arise during the first iteration, such as challenges in integrating third-party APIs (e.g., transport or accommodation services) or delays in receiving customer feedback. To address these risks, we will develop contingency plans that can be quickly implemented to avoid major disruptions to our timeline. For example, if API integration is delayed, we can focus on the UI and navigation elements while waiting for the necessary data. By the end of the meeting, we expect to have a solid plan for the first iteration that includes specific tasks, estimated completion times, and a risk management strategy. This plan will guide the team in delivering the core functionalities of the app within the set timeframe, ensuring we make tangible progress toward creating a valuable tool for international students.

19. Discussions and Lessons Learned

Challenges faced

From the project initiation to the prototyping and user feedback phases, the team faced several challenges that impacted progress and decision-making.

- User insight: Although our project focused on international students, particularly those at JCUB, we encountered various user preferences and insights that created confusion about the system we are developing. The diverse backgrounds and experiences of the students led to differing expectations regarding functionality

and usability. As a result, it became challenging to create a solution that effectively addressed everyone's needs.

- Requirement gathering: Another major challenge was gathering requirements. It was hard to collect clear and complete requirements because stakeholders had different expectations and communication issues. Misunderstandings about project goals made it difficult to identify essential features.
- User Feedback: User feedback was crucial to our project, providing valuable insights into how the system was perceived and used by international students. However, we faced several challenges in this area. Collecting meaningful feedback was difficult due to their own busy schedule and as some were hesitant to share their thoughts.

20. Lesson Learned

1. Teamwork: Effective teamwork is essential for a successful project. Throughout our collaboration, we regularly discussed our progress and provided feedback on each other's work. This collaborative approach not only helped us stay on track but also allowed us to learn from one another.
2. Communication: Clear communication among team members is vital in preventing confusion and miscommunication. By fostering an open dialogue, we ensured that everyone was aligned on goals and expectations, which minimized misunderstandings and facilitated smoother workflow throughout the project.
3. Iterative Development: By breaking the project into smaller phases, we can regularly review our work and gather feedback. This approach helps us adjust to user needs and address issues early, ultimately guiding us toward a better final product as we continue to progress.

21. Conclusion

In conclusion, this project is meticulously crafted to support international students as they navigate the critical tasks upon their arrival, enabling them to fully embrace life in a new city. By carefully identifying stakeholders and selecting target users from the international student community, we ensured that the system aligns with their specific needs. The thoughtful design of survey questionnaires allowed us to gather valuable insights, which directly informed the development of prototypes. Tools like the affinity diagram, empathy map and user stories helped clarify user needs and priorities, while the Gantt chart facilitated effective project management and timeline tracking. Through an iterative process of user feedback and design refinement, we aimed to meet and exceed user expectations, fulfilling the project's core objectives.

Despite facing several challenges, we gained valuable insights that will guide our future designs and enhance our overall strategy. The suggestions from the feedback will be studied and implemented in the main developmental phase. The feedback we received will be thoroughly analysed and integrated into the main development phase. Ultimately, implementing an agile methodology has been key to the project's success, allowing for flexibility and responsiveness throughout the development process.